



Gregor Samsa wakes up in his bed transformed into a giant vermin, lying on his hard domed back with many thin legs waving helplessly, in his small familiar bedroom with textile samples spread on the table and a framed picture of a lady in furs on the wall, while rain drops hit the windowpane in dull grey weather.



Gregor Samsa lies on his back in bed and stares at the alarm clock on the chest of drawers showing almost quarter to seven, realizing he has overslept and missed his train.



Gregor Samsa's mother, father, and sister Grete knock one by one at the locked doors of Gregor's bedroom from outside, calling to him, while Gregor answers from inside in a strange, distorted voice.



Gregor Samsa struggles painfully in his bed, rocking and swinging his huge vermin body, attempting to get out of bed while his many little legs flail helplessly and morning fog presses against the window.





The chief clerk of Gregor's firm arrives at the Samsa family flat and is let in by the maid at the front door, and Gregor Samsa, hearing the visit, finally swings his whole body off the bed and lands with a muffled thump on the carpet.



The chief clerk, Mr. Samsa, and Mrs. Samsa stand outside Gregor's locked bedroom door pressuring him to come out, while Gregor Samsa listens from the floor inside his room, and Grete begins crying in the next room.





Gregor Samsa painfully hauls himself upright against the chest of drawers and then steadies himself against a chair with his little legs, trying to get up in order to open the bedroom door.



Gregor Samsa presses himself against his bedroom door and turns the key in the lock with his jaws, brown fluid dripping from his mouth onto the key and floor, while the family listens excitedly on the other side.





Gregor Samsa slowly turns the open double door with his body and is seen by the family for the first time; the chief clerk recoils with a hand pressed to his mouth, Mrs. Samsa collapses onto the floor in her skirts, and Mr. Samsa clenches his fists and then covers his eyes, weeping.



Gregor Samsa, half his body visible in the doorway, pleads toward the chief clerk in the living room of the flat, but the chief clerk slowly backs away toward the entrance hall and stairs in fear.







Gregor Samsa crawls out onto the landing trying to reach the fleeing chief clerk, who leaps down the staircase; Mrs. Samsa screams and backs into the table knocking over the coffee pot, while Mr. Samsa seizes the chief clerk's stick and a newspaper.



Mr. Samsa hisses and drives Gregor Samsa back toward his bedroom with the chief clerk's stick and a rolled newspaper, stamping his foot, while Mrs. Samsa leans out of an open window and the curtains and papers flutter in the draught.





Gregor Samsa forces himself slowly through the narrow doorway, one side of his body scraped and bleeding against the door, until Mr. Samsa gives him a final shove that sends him bleeding deep into his room and slams the door shut.



In the dark evening, Gregor Samsa painfully crawls toward his bedroom door and discovers a dish of sweetened milk with slices of white bread left there for him by Grete, dips his head into it, then draws back disappointed and crawls away.





Gregor Samsa watches through the crack of his door at night as his family sits silently in the gas-lit living room, then creeps under the couch in his dark room to hide and spends the night there.



The next morning, Grete enters Gregor Samsa's room on tiptoe, finds the untouched milk dish, and brings him a spread of old vegetables, bones with hardened sauce, raisins, cheese, and bread on an old newspaper, then leaves and locks the door so he can eat.







Grete sweeps up the leftovers from Gregor Samsa's room with a broom and drops them into a bin, while Gregor hides under the couch watching her with bulging eyes.



Mr. Samsa sits at the family table explaining the family's finances to Mrs. Samsa and Grete, taking documents from a locked cash box, while Gregor Samsa presses his body against the bedroom door listening and nodding with pleasure.





Gregor Samsa climbs up onto the walls and ceiling of his room, hanging from the ceiling and crawling about for entertainment, leaving small traces of adhesive on the walls.



Grete and Mrs. Samsa laboriously push the heavy chest of drawers out of Gregor Samsa's room to clear space for him, while Gregor hides under the couch covered by a bedsheet he has dragged over himself.



Gregor Samsa crawls out of hiding and clings flat against the framed picture of the lady in furs on his wall, and when Grete and Mrs. Samsa re-enter, Mrs. Samsa sees the enormous brown patch on the wallpaper and collapses onto the couch in shock while Grete shakes her fist at Gregor.



Grete slams the door shut on Gregor Samsa and rushes to fetch smelling salts for her fainting mother, dropping and breaking a bottle that cuts Gregor's face, and Gregor, shut out and confused, crawls frantically over the walls, furniture, and ceiling until he falls onto the dinner table.





Mr. Samsa returns home in a smart blue bank uniform with gold buttons and confronts Gregor Samsa, who has pressed himself against his bedroom door; the father marches stiffly around the room after Gregor, lifting his boots high.



Mr. Samsa hurls red apples from a fruit bowl at Gregor Samsa, one apple striking and lodging itself in Gregor's back, until Mrs. Samsa stumbles forward in her blouse and clings to Mr. Samsa begging him to spare Gregor.







In the family living room during the evening, Mr. Samsa dozes in his chair still wearing his shabby uniform, Mrs. Samsa sews underwear under the lamp, and Grete studies shorthand and French, while Gregor Samsa watches them from the darkness of his room through the open door, the apple wound still in his back.



Grete rushes home in the evening and discovers her mother has cleaned Gregor Samsa's room; Grete breaks into convulsive tears, Mr. Samsa rises in anger, and the parents argue in the living room while Gregor hisses from his room.







The white-haired charwoman discovers Gregor Samsa in his room face to face and, unafraid, stands with hands crossed watching him; thereafter she opens his door each morning and evening, calling out at him, and one morning lifts a chair to threaten him when he moves toward her.



Gregor Samsa's room has become a storage place filled with dustbins and discarded household junk, and three bearded gentlemen lodgers now occupy a room in the flat; Gregor peers through the crack of his door at the lodgers.





The three lodgers eat a steaming dinner of meat and potatoes in the living room served by Mrs. Samsa and Grete, while Gregor Samsa watches hungrily from the darkness of his room, dying of starvation.



Grete plays the violin in the living room while her parents and the three lodgers listen, and Gregor Samsa, drawn out by the music, crawls slowly forward from his room onto the immaculate floor of the living room with his head close to the ground.





The middle lodger points at Gregor Samsa and declares he is giving notice on his room, and the three lodgers withdraw to their room while Mr. Samsa desperately tries to usher them out, and Grete lays her violin on her mother's lap.



In the living room, Grete slams the table and declares to Mr. Samsa and Mrs. Samsa that the creature must be gotten rid of, while Gregor Samsa lies immobile nearby listening, and then slowly turns himself around to crawl back toward his room.





Gregor Samsa crawls back into his room and Grete hurriedly locks and bolts the door behind him; alone in the dark, Gregor lies still as his aching body weakens, and at dawn his head sinks down and he dies quietly.



The charwoman enters Gregor Samsa's room in the morning, prods his dry, flat corpse with her broom, realizes he is dead, and shouts loudly into the dark bedrooms announcing his death.







Mr. Samsa and Mrs. Samsa, in nightclothes, and Grete, fully dressed, gather around Gregor Samsa's dried-up corpse in his room with the charwoman, and Mr. Samsa crosses himself giving thanks to God while Grete looks at the thin body.



The three lodgers emerge looking for their breakfast and the charwoman silently beckons them into Gregor Samsa's room where they stand around the corpse; then Mr. Samsa, supported by Mrs. Samsa and Grete on his arms, orders the lodgers to leave the flat immediately, and the three men bow and depart down the stairs.





Mr. Samsa, Mrs. Samsa, and Grete sit at the family table writing letters of excuse to their employers while the charwoman, hat feather bobbing, cheerfully tells them she has disposed of the body before leaving the flat.





Mr. Samsa, Mrs. Samsa, and Grete leave the flat together and ride an empty sunlit tram out to the open countryside outside the town, leaning back comfortably and discussing their promising prospects and plans to move to a smaller, cheaper flat.



In the warm sunshine of the open countryside, Mr. Samsa and Mrs. Samsa observe with quiet pride that Grete has blossomed into a beautiful young woman, and as they reach their destination Grete stretches out her young body.

